89%

of householder planning applications approved, across the 9 councils we read

The Plan Forecast Planning Decisions Report

October 2026 edition

Across the 9 councils we read (Cheshire West and Chester, Ealing, Leeds, North Yorkshire, Salford, Stockport, Trafford, Wakefield, York), 30,802 householder planning applications were decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025). How many were approved, how long they took, and why the refused were refused, council by council and kind of work by kind of work. Frozen for the October 2026 edition: a figure quoted from it stays true.

Key findings

1 Across the 9 councils we read, 89% of the 30,802 householder planning applications decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were approved (Plan Forecast, Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition).

2 Across the 9 councils we read, half of the 30,798 householder planning applications decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were decided within 55 days, and three quarters within 69 days (Plan Forecast, Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition).

3 Of the 9 councils we read, Wakefield approved the highest share of householder planning applications: 96% of the 889 it decided from June 2025 to September 2026 (Plan Forecast, Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition).

4 Of the 9 councils we read, Leeds approved the lowest share of householder planning applications: 83% of the 7,562 it decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (Plan Forecast, Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition).

5 Of the 9 councils we read, Stockport decided householder planning applications quickest: half of the 3,098 it decided in the 36 months to September 2026 were decided within 42 days (Plan Forecast, Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition).

6 Of the 9 councils we read, Cheshire West and Chester took longest to decide householder planning applications: half of the 3,299 it decided in the 36 months to September 2026 took 65 days or more (Plan Forecast, Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition).

7 Of the 4,601 refused planning applications decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) whose decision notices we read, across 9 councils, 44% were refused at least in part over design or the character of the area (Plan Forecast, Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition).

8 Across the 9 councils we read, new dwellings in gardens were approved least often of the kinds of work we track: 75% of the 583 decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) (Plan Forecast, Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition).

9 Of the 4,601 refused planning applications decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) whose decision notices we read, across 9 councils, 26% were refused at least in part over the effect on neighbours (Plan Forecast, Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition).

10 Of the 4,601 refused planning applications decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) whose decision notices we read, across 9 councils, 19% were refused at least in part over work outside permitted development (Plan Forecast, Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition).

At a glance

89%
of householder planning applications approved

55 days
within which half were decided

30,802
householder applications decided

9
councils read, each by name

Across the 9 councils we read

Every council we read, ranked by the share of householder planning applications it approved, then by how quickly it decided them. Each counts the applications it decided in the 36 months to September 2026, or from the month we began reading its register end to end, as the tables say. The range is where the true rate lies, 95 times in 100.

Share of householder planning applications approved, highest first

Council	Decided	Approved	Range	Counted from
Wakefield	889	96%	94–97%	June 2025
Stockport	3,098	95%	94–96%	October 2023
Cheshire West and Chester	3,299	94%	93–94%	October 2023
North Yorkshire	5,813	92%	92–93%	October 2023
Salford	1,416	90%	88–91%	October 2023
York	2,000	88%	86–89%	October 2023
Trafford	3,567	85%	84–86%	October 2023
Ealing	3,158	85%	84–86%	March 2025
Leeds	7,562	83%	82–84%	October 2023

Days to decide a householder planning application, quickest first

Council	With dates	A quarter within	Half within	Three quarters within
Stockport	3,098	32 days	42 days	54 days
Leeds	7,562	48 days	54 days	56 days
Trafford	3,567	48 days	55 days	59 days
Ealing	3,158	46 days	56 days	80 days
North Yorkshire	5,813	49 days	56 days	72 days
Wakefield	889	50 days	56 days	76 days
York	2,000	55 days	56 days	79 days
Salford	1,412	55 days	57 days	79 days
Cheshire West and Chester	3,299	47 days	65 days	105 days

Approval by kind of work

Across the 9 councils we read, each kind of work the applications were for, decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025). Householder work is the first seven; a new dwelling in a garden and a change of use are not householder applications, and are not in the figures above.

Share approved and days to decide, by kind of work

Kind of work	Councils	Decided	Approved	Half within
Rear extension	9	10,242	92%	53 days
Side extension	9	2,174	93%	55 days
Two-storey extension	9	7,511	84%	56 days
Loft conversion or dormer	9	5,320	86%	55 days
Garden room or outbuilding	9	3,805	87%	56 days
Garage conversion	9	633	93%	54 days
Front porch	9	1,117	91%	55 days
New dwelling in a garden	9	583	75%	106 days
Change of use	9	6,045	80%	72 days

Why refusals happen

We read the decision notices of 4,601 of the 4,832 applications 9 of the councils refused in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025), and sorted each reason given into one of thirteen topics. A refusal usually gives more than one reason, so the shares add up to more than 100%.

What the refusals were about, across the 9 councils whose notices we read enough of

Topic	Refusals	Share of those read
Design and character of the area	2,028	44%
Neighbours' amenity	1,178	26%
Not permitted development	887	19%
Insufficient information	511	11%
Living conditions for future occupiers	479	10%
Highways and parking	463	10%
Heritage assets	449	10%
Green Belt and open countryside	368	8%
Trees, landscape and ecology	193	4%
Principle of development	164	4%
Flooding and drainage	75	2%
Conflict with neighbouring land uses	31	1%
Other	20	0%

The commonest topics, council by council: share of its refusals read

Council	Read	Design and character of the area	Neighbours' amenity	Not permitted development	Insufficient information	Living conditions for future occupiers
Cheshire West and Chester	306	53%	22%	16%	13%	3%
Ealing	540	34%	22%	31%	13%	26%
Leeds	1,606	48%	27%	19%	9%	9%
North Yorkshire	695	37%	20%	16%	18%	6%
Salford	223	34%	40%	14%	12%	19%
Stockport	178	28%	24%	31%	9%	13%
Trafford	590	57%	27%	24%	4%	4%
Wakefield	73	34%	29%	4%	25%	18%
York	390	44%	28%	6%	9%	8%

New this edition

This is the first edition. Each month's edition is frozen at its own address, so a figure quoted from it stays true; the next adds the councils we have begun to read since.

Questions this report answers

What share of householder planning applications are approved?

Across the 9 councils we read (Cheshire West and Chester, Ealing, Leeds, North Yorkshire, Salford, Stockport, Trafford, Wakefield and York), 89% of the 30,802 householder planning applications decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were approved; the rest were refused. Withdrawn applications are left out of the rate.

How long does planning permission take for a householder application?

Across the 9 councils we read, half of the 30,798 householder planning applications decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were decided within 55 days of being validated (or received, where the register gives no validation day). A quarter were decided within 47 days, and three quarters within 69 days.

Which council approves the most householder planning applications?

Of the 9 councils we read, Wakefield approved the highest share (96% of 889) and Leeds the lowest (83% of 7,562). The report's tables rank every council with enough decisions to say.

Which council decides householder planning applications quickest?

Of the 9 councils we read, Stockport decided householder planning applications quickest: half of the 3,098 it decided in the 36 months to September 2026 were decided within 42 days. The report's tables rank every council with enough decisions to say.

Why is planning permission refused?

Of the 4,601 refused applications decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) whose decision notices we read, the reasons most often given were about design or the character of the area (44%), the effect on neighbours (26%) and work outside permitted development (19%). A refusal often gives more than one reason, so the shares add up to more than 100%.

How often is planning permission granted for rear extensions?

Across the 9 councils we read, 92% of the 10,242 rear extensions decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were approved, and half were decided within 53 days. Withdrawn applications are left out of the rate.

How often is planning permission granted for side extensions?

Across the 9 councils we read, 93% of the 2,174 side extensions decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were approved, and half were decided within 55 days. Withdrawn applications are left out of the rate.

How often is planning permission granted for two-storey extensions?

Across the 9 councils we read, 84% of the 7,511 two-storey extensions decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were approved, and half were decided within 56 days. Withdrawn applications are left out of the rate.

How often is planning permission granted for loft conversions and dormers?

Across the 9 councils we read, 86% of the 5,320 loft conversions and dormers decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were approved, and half were decided within 55 days. Withdrawn applications are left out of the rate.

How often is planning permission granted for garden rooms and outbuildings?

Across the 9 councils we read, 87% of the 3,805 garden rooms and outbuildings decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were approved, and half were decided within 56 days. Withdrawn applications are left out of the rate.

How often is planning permission granted for garage conversions?

Across the 9 councils we read, 93% of the 633 garage conversions decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were approved, and half were decided within 54 days. Withdrawn applications are left out of the rate.

How often is planning permission granted for front porches?

Across the 9 councils we read, 91% of the 1,117 front porches decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were approved, and half were decided within 55 days. Withdrawn applications are left out of the rate.

How often is planning permission granted for new dwellings in gardens?

Across the 9 councils we read, 75% of the 583 new dwellings in gardens decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were approved, and half were decided within 106 days. Withdrawn applications are left out of the rate.

How often is planning permission granted for changes of use?

Across the 9 councils we read, 80% of the 6,045 changes of use decided in the 36 months to September 2026 (for Ealing, since March 2025; for Wakefield, since June 2025) were approved, and half were decided within 72 days. Withdrawn applications are left out of the rate.

What share of householder planning applications does Cheshire West and Chester approve, and how quickly?

Cheshire West and Chester approved 94% of the 3,299 householder planning applications it decided in the 36 months to September 2026, and decided half within 65 days. Of its 306 refusals in that time whose decision notices we read, of every kind of work we track, the reasons most often given were about design or the character of the area (53%), harm to the Green Belt or open countryside (24%) and the effect on neighbours (22%).

What share of householder planning applications does Ealing approve, and how quickly?

Ealing approved 85% of the 3,158 householder planning applications it decided from March 2025 to September 2026, and decided half within 56 days. Of its 540 refusals in that time whose decision notices we read, of every kind of work we track, the reasons most often given were about design or the character of the area (34%), work outside permitted development (31%) and poor living conditions for future occupiers (26%).

What share of householder planning applications does Leeds approve, and how quickly?

Leeds approved 83% of the 7,562 householder planning applications it decided in the 36 months to September 2026, and decided half within 54 days. Of its 1,606 refusals in that time whose decision notices we read, of every kind of work we track, the reasons most often given were about design or the character of the area (48%), the effect on neighbours (27%) and work outside permitted development (19%).

What share of householder planning applications does North Yorkshire approve, and how quickly?

North Yorkshire approved 92% of the 5,813 householder planning applications it decided in the 36 months to September 2026, and decided half within 56 days. Of its 695 refusals in that time whose decision notices we read, of every kind of work we track, the reasons most often given were about design or the character of the area (37%), harm to heritage (20%) and the effect on neighbours (20%).

What share of householder planning applications does Salford approve, and how quickly?

Salford approved 90% of the 1,416 householder planning applications it decided in the 36 months to September 2026, and decided half within 57 days. Of its 223 refusals in that time whose decision notices we read, of every kind of work we track, the reasons most often given were about the effect on neighbours (40%), design or the character of the area (34%) and poor living conditions for future occupiers (19%).

What share of householder planning applications does Stockport approve, and how quickly?

Stockport approved 95% of the 3,098 householder planning applications it decided in the 36 months to September 2026, and decided half within 42 days. Of its 178 refusals in that time whose decision notices we read, of every kind of work we track, the reasons most often given were about work outside permitted development (31%), design or the character of the area (28%) and the effect on neighbours (24%).

What share of householder planning applications does Trafford approve, and how quickly?

Trafford approved 85% of the 3,567 householder planning applications it decided in the 36 months to September 2026, and decided half within 55 days. Of its 590 refusals in that time whose decision notices we read, of every kind of work we track, the reasons most often given were about design or the character of the area (57%), the effect on neighbours (27%) and work outside permitted development (24%).

What share of householder planning applications does Wakefield approve, and how quickly?

Wakefield approved 96% of the 889 householder planning applications it decided from June 2025 to September 2026, and decided half within 56 days. Of its 73 refusals in that time whose decision notices we read, of every kind of work we track, the reasons most often given were about design or the character of the area (34%), the effect on neighbours (29%) and insufficient information (25%).

What share of householder planning applications does York approve, and how quickly?

York approved 88% of the 2,000 householder planning applications it decided in the 36 months to September 2026, and decided half within 56 days. Of its 390 refusals in that time whose decision notices we read, of every kind of work we track, the reasons most often given were about design or the character of the area (44%), the effect on neighbours (28%) and highways or parking (19%).

Where do these figures come from?

From each council's own planning register, read by Plan Forecast: every decision the register lists in the window that we sorted into one of the 9 kinds of work we track, counted by council and kind. Decisions on anything else (trees, conditions, certificates and the like) are not counted. A figure resting on fewer than 30 decisions is held back. The figures are frozen for this edition and never change.

How do I cite this report?

Plan Forecast (2026). The Plan Forecast Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition. https://planforecast.co.uk/research/planning-decisions/2026-10. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23327502
The data is free to reuse under CC BY 4.0, with that attribution.

How this was made, and what it leaves out

Every decision each council's own planning register lists, decided between October 2023 and September 2026, that we sorted into one of the 9 kinds of work we track, counted on 2026-10-22 and frozen. Decisions on anything else (trees, conditions, certificates and the like) are not counted, and nor is a decision only a third party holds.

The councils are those Plan Forecast reads in full and sells reports for: Cheshire West and Chester, Ealing, Leeds, North Yorkshire, Salford, Stockport, Trafford, Wakefield, York. They are not a sample of England, and nothing here is a figure for the country.

Each application is sorted into a kind of work by its description. "Householder" is the first seven kinds: extensions, lofts and dormers, garden rooms and outbuildings, garage conversions and porches.

The share approved is of applications granted or refused; a withdrawn application is in neither. Days to decide run from the day an application was validated, or received where no validation day is given, to its decision, over those granted or refused; a decision dated before it was received is a bad date, and not counted in the times. Each time is a day some decision took, so "half within" is true of the decisions counted.

A figure resting on fewer than 30 decisions is held back (for days to decide, fewer than 30 with the dates to count from), and a council's refusal topics are shown only where we read at least 30 of its refusals and half of them. A refusal whose notice we have not read is counted as a refusal, never as one without reasons.

These figures differ from the council pages on our site, which are counted afresh each day over the last three years; an edition counts to the end of the month before it and never changes.

Counts only: no application is named or placed, and nothing a council wrote is quoted.

Cheshire West and Chester: decisions in the 36 months to September 2026.

Ealing: decisions from March 2025 to September 2026.

Leeds: decisions in the 36 months to September 2026.

North Yorkshire: decisions in the 36 months to September 2026.

Salford: decisions in the 36 months to September 2026.

Stockport: decisions in the 36 months to September 2026.

Trafford: decisions in the 36 months to September 2026.

Wakefield: decisions from June 2025 to September 2026.

York: decisions in the 36 months to September 2026.

Cite this report

Plan Forecast (2026). The Plan Forecast Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition. https://planforecast.co.uk/research/planning-decisions/2026-10. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23327502

```
@techreport{planforecast_2026_10,
  author = {{Plan Forecast}},
  title = {The Plan Forecast Planning Decisions Report, October 2026 edition},
  year = {2026},
  month = {10},
  url = {https://planforecast.co.uk/research/planning-decisions/2026-10},
  doi = {10.5281/zenodo.23327502}
}
```

The DOI 10.5281/zenodo.23327502 (https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23327502) names every edition's data; each edition is a version of it.

The data

Every figure in this edition, free to reuse with attribution under CC BY 4.0, frozen as it was published. The same files are on GitHub, Zenodo, Kaggle and Hugging Face.

Decisions (CSV) (https://planforecast.co.uk/data/editions/2026-10/decisions.csv)

Decisions (JSON) (https://planforecast.co.uk/data/editions/2026-10/decisions.json)

Refusal reasons (CSV) (https://planforecast.co.uk/data/editions/2026-10/refusal-reasons.csv)

Refusal reasons (JSON) (https://planforecast.co.uk/data/editions/2026-10/refusal-reasons.json)

This edition as a PDF (https://planforecast.co.uk/research/planning-decisions/2026-10.pdf)

This edition as text (https://planforecast.co.uk/research/planning-decisions/2026-10.md)